

The Boston Globe

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FRIDAY, AUGUST 1, 2025

‘I’m not looking for sympathy.
I want to be able to just do my job again.’

US DISTRICT JUDGE JOHN J. MCCONNELL JR.

Judge who ruled against Trump describes threats

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — A Rhode Island federal judge on Thursday for the first time detailed the scope and impact of the harassment he was subjected to after issuing a ruling against the Trump administration.

During a virtual panel discussion on intimidation of the judiciary, US District Judge John J. McConnell Jr. shared audio of an expletive-laden voicemail calling for him to be assassinated and thrown in prison, and spoke about receiving multiple credible death threats.

After he issued a ruling this year blocking the administration’s early attempts to freeze federal funding, he said, he also received multiple pizza deliveries at his home designed to send a clear message: we know where you live.

“I’ve been on the bench almost 15 years, and I must say it’s the one time that actually shook my faith in the judicial system and the rule of law,” McConnell said of receiving the voicemail and 400 calls attacking and threatening him for his ruling.

McConnell was one of five sitting

JUDGES, Page A6

At Brown, deal fuels outrage over curtailing trans rights

Students question wisdom of concessions

By Steph Machado
and Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — Current and former students at Brown University expressed alarm Thursday at the university’s decision to adopt the Trump administration’s definition of “male” and “female,” arguing it shuns transgender and nonbinary students on a campus that is typically a beacon of inclusivity.

Brown agreed to adopt the definitions from President Trump’s executive orders on “restoring biological truth” and “keeping men out of women’s sports” as part of a sweeping agreement that restores millions of

scientific research dollars to the university, and resolves an investigation by the federal government into alleged antisemitism on campus.

Those concessions are all the more notable on a campus where nearly 40 percent of students do not identify as straight, according to a 2023 survey published by the school newspaper, the Brown Daily Herald. Just over 22 percent of Gen Z identifies as LGBTQ+, according to a recent Gallup poll.

“To have made an agreement on the backs of our queer and trans friends is really shameful,” said Talia Reiss, co-president of Planned Parent-

hood Advocates at Brown, a student club that advocates for reproductive rights and gender-affirming care.

“Students want to feel like their identities are supported by the university,” Reiss said.

Reiss and co-president Cara Hutton, who are both studying public health, said the group was not “immediately concerned” about Brown’s promise, as part of the agreement, to not provide gender-affirming surgery or puberty blockers to minors, since few students at the university are under 18.

Brown has never performed such surgeries, and said it would refer those students to outside medical

BROWN, Page A5



Pushed to the edge, hanging onto hope

Friends Beata Kosc (far right) and Courtney Doyon posed for a photo on the summit of Mount Katahdin in Maine. The weather forced them to spend the night above treeline, and Kosc (wrapped up) had to be taken out by helicopter because she’d injured her knee.



PHOTOS COURTESY OF BEATA KOSC

Bad weather and bad luck turned a summer day on Mount Katahdin into a hiker’s nightmare

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

Stranded on the rugged upper reaches of Mount Katahdin in Maine, Beata Kosc prayed for mercy in the night.

Along the exposed ridges and rocky slopes of the Knife Edge trail, she huddled last Thursday with her friend and two other shivering hikers. Roaring winds from the west threatened to push them off the path. Freezing rain pelted their bodies.

Aching and unable to move, Kosc, 47, of New York, made peace with the possibility of death. Rescuers were hours away. Later, she would reason, the ordeal was part of a divine plan.

“It was so difficult to stay put,” she said. “I’m incredibly grateful that I listened to my heart.”

Rising just shy of a mile above sea level, Katahdin means the “greatest mountain” in the Penobscot language.

The crown jewel of Baxter State Park, Maine’s highest peak draws tens of thousands to the northern wilderness each year. But even the friendlier trails carry risks. And the peak’s mercurial climate can turn quickly, even in the summer, imperiling ill-equipped and unlucky hikers.

More than 60 people have died on Katahdin since officials began tracking deaths in

HIKERS, Page A7

With mother held by ICE, two daughters in DCF care missing

By John R. Ellement,
Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio,
and Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

Two teenage daughters of a woman detained by federal immigration agents during a dramatic confrontation in Worcester in May are now missing after being placed in the custody of the state’s foster care system.

The mother, Rosane Ferreira de Oliveira, was taken into custody by Immigration and

Customs Enforcement in a chaotic scene in which protesters clashed with federal agents and local police. Images of a distraught Ferreira de Oliveira with one of her now-missing daughters, Nayara Ferreira de Moura, 17, pleading for her release were among the first to capture the intensity and agony of the Trump administration’s aggressive approach to immigration enforcement.

After their mother’s arrest, Nayara Ferreira de Moura and a second daughter, Karoline Ferreira de Moura, 13, were placed

in the custody of the Department of Children and Families. On Thursday, Worcester police confirmed there was an ongoing investigation to locate the 13-year-old, Karoline, who is considered an “endangered runaway due to her age,” spokesman Joseph Cersosimo said.

The National Center for Missing and Exploited Children lists both of the sisters as missing on its website.

An attorney for the family told the Mass-

MISSING, Page A7

Bar advocates say raises fall far short

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

The state’s criminal courts appear headed for weeks more uncertainty after dozens of private attorneys who represent indigent clients criticized a pay raise from the Legislature as insufficient and threatened to continue a work stoppage that has paralyzed parts of the judicial system.

“We’re going nowhere,” Sean Delaney, one of the lawyers, known as bar advocates, said during a demonstration at the State House on Thursday, steps from where Beacon Hill leaders were preparing to vote on their proposed solution. “Your ridiculous propos-

al that you put forward yesterday is only strengthening our resolve.”

On Thursday, lawmakers approved a fast-moving bill to raise the pay for private attorneys by \$10 an hour this year, and another \$10 next year. The legislation would also dramatically expand the number of salaried attorneys who work for the state public defender agency, so the courts would be less reliant on private attorneys and less vulnerable to work stoppages.

The private attorneys began their work stoppage in May, noting the \$65 an hour many are paid is far below

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VOL. 308, NO. 32

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



End of the weak days

Friday: Drizzle, then clearing.
High 69-74. Low 59-64.

Saturday: Beautiful.
High 73-78. Low 61-66.

Sunrise: 5:37 Sunset: 8:04

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

Sox bolster pitching at deadline

They acquired starter Dustin May from the Dodgers and reliever Steven Matz from the Cardinals, but many fans were hoping the front office would do a lot more. **C1.**

